

Wardle Editorial Canon

Standards for Governed Editorial Artifacts

Part I — Canon Foundations

1. Purpose of the Canon

The Wardle Editorial Canon defines the authoritative editorial meaning, quality expectations, governance requirements, and lifecycle principles of the artifacts governed by the Wardle Editorial Operating System.

The WEOS Architecture defines the overall philosophy and conceptual structure of the editorial system.

The Canon defines how that philosophy applies to specific editorial artifacts.

It establishes:

- what each artifact means
- why each artifact exists
- what educational function it serves
- what dependencies it possesses
- how it may be created
- how it must be reviewed
- what constitutes acceptable quality
- what decisions may be made about it
- when it may influence learner-facing content
- how it is maintained throughout its lifetime

The Canon is not a database specification.

It is not an API contract.

It is not a description of the current user interface.

It is the editorial standard from which those implementations should be derived.

2. Authority of the Canon

The Canon is subordinate to the principles established in the WEOS Architecture and authoritative over artifact-specific editorial behaviour.

Where implementation and Canon diverge, the divergence should be identified explicitly.

Implementation should not silently redefine the meaning of an editorial artifact.

The Canon may therefore describe:

1. **Current implementation**

How the artifact presently exists within Wardle.

2. **Canonical meaning**

What the artifact represents within WEOS.

3. **Required evolution**

Changes necessary to align implementation with the canonical model.

This distinction prevents the Canon from becoming either:

- a passive description of existing code, or
- an aspirational document disconnected from the product.

The Canon connects present implementation to intended editorial architecture.

3. Scope

The Canon applies to every artifact that contributes to the creation, governance, delivery, or maintenance of diagnostic education within Wardle.

These include:

- diagnosis registry entities
- diagnosis metadata
- editorial briefs
- learning goals
- teaching rules
- diagnostic relationships
- evidence relationships
- clinical cases
- case revisions
- clues
- clue-progression assessments
- differentials
- diagnosis education
- educational sections
- graph candidates
- graph facts

- AI-generated drafts
- validation records
- editorial reviews
- publication decisions
- governance history

The Canon also applies to future artifact types introduced into WEOS.

Every new artifact should receive a Canon standard before becoming a mature editorial capability.

4. Foundational Distinctions

The Canon depends upon several distinctions that must remain explicit throughout WEOS.

4.1 Diagnosis and Case

A diagnosis is a governed clinical knowledge entity.

A clinical case is an educational expression of that diagnosis.

A case may teach one diagnosis through a particular presentation, learner level, reasoning pathway, and clue progression.

The diagnosis remains the enduring knowledge entity.

The case remains one instructional implementation.

A diagnosis may exist without a case.

A case should not exist without a resolved or explicitly governed diagnosis relationship.

4.2 Educational Intent and Learner-Facing Content

Educational intent defines what Wardle intends learners to understand.

Learner-facing content communicates that intent.

Educational intent is represented through artifacts such as:

- learning goals
- teaching rules
- required mimics
- required pitfalls

- investigation anchors
- management anchors
- generation guidance

Learner-facing content includes:

- clinical cases
- explanations
- diagnosis education
- recall prompts
- educational summaries

Content should be evaluated against approved educational intent.

Content should not define educational intent accidentally.

4.3 Candidate Knowledge and Governed Knowledge

Candidate knowledge is proposed knowledge awaiting editorial judgement.

Governed knowledge has undergone the required editorial decision process.

Examples of candidate knowledge include:

- a graph candidate
- an AI-generated clue revision
- an unresolved differential mapping
- a draft teaching relationship
- generated diagnosis education
- a proposed teaching rule

Candidate knowledge may be clinically plausible without being institutionally trusted.

Governed knowledge requires an explicit decision.

4.4 Approval and Publication

Approval and publication are separate editorial concepts.

Approval indicates that an artifact has satisfied its required editorial review.

Publication indicates that an approved artifact has been authorised for learner exposure or operational use.

An artifact may be:

- approved but not published
- published and later superseded
- approved but blocked by diagnosis-level dependencies
- editorially valid but not playable
- playable but not scheduled for release

The system must not treat approval, readiness, playability, and publication as synonyms.

4.5 Editorial Status and Operational Status

Editorial status describes governance.

Operational status describes availability or use.

Examples of editorial states include:

- draft
- needs review
- needs edit
- approved
- rejected

Examples of operational states include:

- playable
- generatable
- active
- published
- archived
- scheduled

A diagnosis may be active in the registry while still requiring editorial development.

A case may be approved while not yet ready for publication.

Diagnosis education may be approved while not yet published.

These distinctions must remain visible in both policy and implementation.

5. Universal Artifact Standard

Every governed editorial artifact should be describable through a common canonical structure.

5.1 Identity

Every artifact must possess a stable identity independent of its current wording or revision.

Identity enables:

- revision history
- governance continuity
- relationship tracking
- supersession
- auditability

A revision changes an artifact.

It does not necessarily create a new conceptual artifact.

5.2 Artifact Type

Every artifact must have a clearly defined editorial type.

The artifact type determines:

- its purpose
- its quality standard
- its lifecycle
- its generation policy
- its review requirements
- its publication behaviour

Artifact type should represent editorial meaning rather than merely storage format.

5.3 Diagnosis Context

Every diagnosis-scoped artifact must preserve its relationship to the diagnosis registry.

Where the artifact connects more than one diagnosis, the source and target roles must be explicit.

Examples include:

- differential relationships
- teaching relationships
- mimic relationships
- contradiction relationships
- graph relationships

Textual diagnosis names alone are insufficient where registry resolution is possible.

5.4 Purpose

Every artifact must have an explicit editorial or educational purpose.

Purpose answers:

- Why does this artifact exist?
- Which editorial problem does it solve?
- Which learner outcome does it support?
- Which other artifacts depend upon it?

An artifact without a defined purpose should not become governed knowledge.

5.5 Source and Provenance

Every artifact must preserve how it originated.

Possible sources include:

- manual authoring
- AI-assisted generation
- imported knowledge
- administrative revision
- restoration
- extraction from existing education
- extraction from a case
- migration from legacy content

Source establishes provenance.

It does not establish authority.

5.6 Version and Revision

Artifacts that can change materially must support version or revision history.

Revision history should preserve:

- previous content
- source of the revision
- author or generator

- creation time
- validation outcome
- review decision
- publication relationship

The current version should never erase the governed history of earlier versions.

5.7 Lifecycle State

Every artifact must have a defined lifecycle appropriate to its type.

There is no requirement that all artifacts use the same status vocabulary.

A clinical case, diagnosis education record, graph candidate, differential mapping, and teaching relationship represent different editorial processes and may therefore require different states.

However, every lifecycle must make the following conceptual distinctions possible:

- not yet governed
- awaiting review
- revision required
- accepted
- rejected
- no longer current

Where relevant, the lifecycle should also distinguish:

- validated
 - ready for publication
 - published
 - archived
 - deprecated
 - superseded
 - merged
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5.8 Dependencies

Every artifact must identify the knowledge and decisions upon which it depends.

Dependencies may include:

- diagnosis metadata
- approved teaching rules
- educational brief

- differential resolution
- supporting evidence
- case revision
- approved graph relationship
- learning-goal coverage
- validation outcome

Dependencies should guide editorial progression.

They should not be hidden implementation assumptions.

5.9 Assessments

Artifacts may be evaluated through one or more editorial assessments.

Examples include:

- clinical correctness
- reasoning quality
- educational value
- evidence sufficiency
- clue coherence
- differential coverage
- learner safety
- publication readiness

Assessments interpret the artifact.

They do not themselves constitute approval.

5.10 Blockers and Warnings

The Canon distinguishes blockers from warnings.

A **blocker** prevents a defined lifecycle transition.

A **warning** identifies risk or incompleteness that does not necessarily prevent transition.

Every blocker should state:

- what requirement failed
- why it matters
- which transition it prevents
- what action can resolve it

Warnings should not be presented as blockers merely because they are important.

Blockers should not be hidden among general quality signals.

5.11 Editorial Decision

Every governed artifact must support explicit editorial decisions appropriate to its lifecycle.

Possible decisions include:

- approve
- reject
- request changes
- request evidence
- resolve
- defer
- merge
- supersede
- deprecate
- archive
- publish
- withdraw

A decision should preserve:

- responsible reviewer
 - decision time
 - rationale
 - affected version
 - supporting assessment
 - resulting state
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5.12 Available Actions

The actions available for an artifact should be derived from:

- artifact type
- current state
- reviewer role
- unresolved blockers
- dependency state
- applicable policy

The presence of an action should never imply that the action is safe.

Editorial Intelligence should determine whether an action is currently permissible and explain why.

5.13 Audit History

Every meaningful editorial action should contribute to an auditable history.

Audit history should make it possible to reconstruct:

- what existed
- what changed
- who or what changed it
- why it changed
- who reviewed it
- what decision was made
- what was exposed to learners

Audit history is part of the artifact's governance, not secondary metadata.

6. Canonical Knowledge States

Although individual artifacts use different lifecycle vocabularies, WEOS recognises several universal conceptual states.

6.1 Absent

The artifact does not yet exist.

Absence is not failure by itself.

It becomes an editorial deficiency only where policy requires the artifact.

6.2 Suggested

The system or an editor has identified a potential need.

A suggestion is not yet authored content.

Examples include:

- suggested differential
- suggested graph relationship

- suggested case
 - suggested teaching objective
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6.3 Candidate

A proposed artifact exists but has not completed governance.

Candidate status is appropriate for artifacts such as graph relationships, evidence relationships, and teaching relationships.

6.4 Draft

The artifact has authored content but remains under development.

Draft status does not imply that formal review has begun.

6.5 Generated

The artifact was produced through an automated or AI-assisted process.

Generated describes origin or production state.

It must not be interpreted as approval.

6.6 Awaiting Review

The artifact is sufficiently complete for human editorial evaluation.

Examples may be expressed in implementation as:

- review
 - needs review
 - pending review
 - review required
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6.7 Revision Required

A reviewer or validator has determined that changes are required.

Examples may be expressed as:

- needs edit
- request changes
- failed validation
- unresolved
- ambiguous

Revision required should always include actionable rationale.

6.8 Approved

The artifact has satisfied its defined editorial review.

Approval applies to a specific artifact version.

Approval does not automatically imply publication, playability, activation, or scheduling.

6.9 Ready for Operational Use

The artifact has satisfied the dependencies required for its intended operational role.

Examples include:

- ready to publish
- playable
- generatable
- active
- ready for review at diagnosis level

Readiness must always identify the operation for which the artifact is ready.

6.10 Published

The artifact is authorised for learner-facing or institutional use.

Publication should always be traceable to an approved version and explicit publication decision.

6.11 Rejected

The artifact has been reviewed and not accepted into governed knowledge.

Rejection should preserve the artifact and decision history unless policy explicitly permits deletion.

6.12 Superseded, Deprecated, or Archived

The artifact is no longer the preferred current representation.

These states have different meanings:

- **Superseded** — replaced by a newer governed artifact.
- **Deprecated** — retained but no longer recommended for ongoing use.
- **Archived** — removed from active use while history is preserved.

The Canon should not use these terms interchangeably.

6.13 Merged

The artifact has been consolidated into another artifact.

Merged artifacts should preserve:

- original identity
 - destination artifact
 - merge rationale
 - governance decision
 - provenance contribution
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7. Current Wardle Lifecycle Vocabulary

Current Wardle implementation already contains several distinct lifecycle models.

Clinical Cases

Cases progress through states including:

- Draft
- Validating
- Validated
- Review
- Needs Edit
- Approved
- Ready to Publish

- Published
- Rejected

This lifecycle combines editorial review, validation, publication readiness, and publication state.

The Canon should preserve the meaning of these stages while ensuring that approval and publication remain distinct.

Diagnosis Education

Diagnosis education currently supports:

- Draft
- Generated
- Needs Review
- Needs Edit
- Approved
- Published
- Rejected
- Archived

This lifecycle explicitly recognises generated content as separate from reviewed content.

Graph Candidates

Graph candidates currently support:

- Candidate
- Approved
- Rejected
- Merged

A graph candidate may be promoted into an active graph fact.

Teaching Relationships

Teaching relationships currently support:

- Candidate
- Needs Review
- Active
- Rejected
- Deprecated

The use of `Active` reflects operational graph participation and should not be treated as identical to generic approval.

Differential Resolution

Differential mappings currently support:

- Resolved
- Ambiguous
- Unresolved
- Rejected

These states describe identity resolution rather than editorial publication.

Diagnosis Editorial Onboarding

Diagnosis onboarding currently progresses through:

- New
- Rules Started
- Brief Started
- Education Started
- Case Started
- Ready for Review
- Complete

This is a diagnosis-development progression, not the lifecycle of a single artifact.

The Canon should retain these conceptual differences rather than force every artifact into one universal enum.

8. Canonical Source Categories

WEOS recognises several broad source categories.

Human Authored

Produced directly by an editor or clinical author.

AI Assisted

Produced with meaningful AI contribution and subject to human governance.

Generated

Produced primarily through an automated generation process.

Imported

Introduced from an external structured or unstructured source.

Extracted

Derived from an existing Wardle artifact, such as graph candidates extracted from diagnosis education or case reasoning.

Administrative Revision

Produced through direct editorial repair, migration, or controlled administrative correction.

Restored

Recovered from an earlier trusted source or historical version.

Source categories should remain separate from review status and publication status.

9. Canonical Artifact Families

The Canon groups artifacts into six families.

9.1 Diagnosis Foundation Artifacts

- Diagnosis Registry Entry
- Diagnosis Metadata
- Diagnosis Editorial Brief
- Learning Goals
- Teaching Rules

9.2 Clinical Case Artifacts

- Clinical Case
- Case Revision
- Case Clue
- Case Explanation
- Case Differential
- Clue Progression Analysis
- Clue-Discriminator Annotation
- Learning-Goal Coverage
- Validation Run
- Case Review

9.3 Diagnosis Education Artifacts

- Diagnosis Education
- Summary
- Clinical Pattern
- Key Symptoms
- Key Signs
- Examination Pearls
- Scoring Systems
- Investigations
- Differentials
- Management
- Complications
- Pitfalls
- Recall Prompts
- References

9.4 Knowledge and Reasoning Artifacts

- Graph Candidate
- Graph Fact
- Teaching Relationship
- Evidence Node
- Evidence Relationship
- Reasoning Path
- Diagnostic Comparison
- Differential Link

9.5 Candidate and AI Draft Artifacts

- AI Draft Audit
- Clue Revision Draft
- Generated Education Draft
- Suggested Teaching Rule
- Suggested Relationship
- Suggested Case

9.6 Governance Artifacts

- Editorial Assessment
 - Editorial Review
 - Editorial Decision
 - Validation Result
 - Publication Decision
 - Governance History
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10. Canonical Review Principle

Every artifact must be reviewed according to its own purpose.

A case should not be reviewed using only education-section standards.

A graph relationship should not be reviewed as though it were prose.

A teaching rule should not be assessed merely for factual correctness.

A differential mapping should not be approved solely because the text appears clinically plausible.

The Canon therefore defines artifact-specific quality standards while preserving a common governance structure.

11. Canonical Publication Principle

Not every artifact is directly learner-facing.

Artifacts may be classified as:

Learner-Facing

Directly visible to learners.

Examples include:

- cases
- explanations
- diagnosis education
- recall prompts

Learner-Influencing

Not necessarily visible but materially shaping learner-facing content.

Examples include:

- teaching rules
- learning goals
- reasoning paths
- graph relationships
- generation guidance

Editorial-Only

Used to govern or assess content.

Examples include:

- validation runs
- draft audits
- review records
- unsupported-claim signals
- readiness assessments

Publication policy must account for all three categories.

Editorial-only artifacts may block publication despite never being shown to learners.

12. Normative Statements

The following statements apply throughout the Canon.

- Every governed artifact **MUST** possess a stable editorial identity.
 - Every artifact **MUST** have a defined purpose.
 - Every artifact **MUST** preserve its source or provenance.
 - Every artifact **MUST** have an appropriate lifecycle.
 - Every material revision **MUST** preserve history.
 - Every approval **MUST** apply to an identifiable artifact version.
 - Every editorial decision **MUST** preserve reviewer accountability and rationale.
 - AI-generated content **MUST NOT** become governed knowledge without human editorial review.
 - Approval **MUST NOT** be treated as synonymous with publication.
 - Publication **MUST NOT** occur without an explicit publication decision.
 - Candidate knowledge **MUST NOT** be presented as institutionally trusted knowledge.
 - Rejected and superseded artifacts **SHOULD** remain historically traceable.
 - Lifecycle states **MUST** reflect the meaning of the artifact rather than convenience of implementation.
 - Blockers **MUST** identify the transition they prevent.
 - Readiness conclusions **MUST** be explainable.
 - Learner-facing artifacts **MUST** be traceable to governed editorial intent.
 - Implementations **SHOULD** reuse canonical terminology wherever doing so does not erase necessary domain distinctions.
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13. Relationship to Subsequent Parts

The remaining sections of the Canon apply these foundations to individual artifact families.

Part II defines Diagnosis Governance standards.

Part III defines Clinical Case standards.

Part IV defines Diagnosis Education standards.

Part V defines Knowledge and Reasoning Governance standards.

Part VI defines AI Draft standards.

Part VII defines Governance Record standards.

Each artifact chapter should use the universal standard established in this Part while specifying its own quality requirements, dependencies, decisions, and lifecycle.

Closing Principle

The purpose of the Wardle Editorial Canon is not to make every artifact identical.

Its purpose is to make every artifact understandable, governable, and trustworthy.

Artifacts differ in function, lifecycle, and educational role.

They are unified by explicit purpose, transparent provenance, versioned history, appropriate review, explainable decisions, and accountable governance.